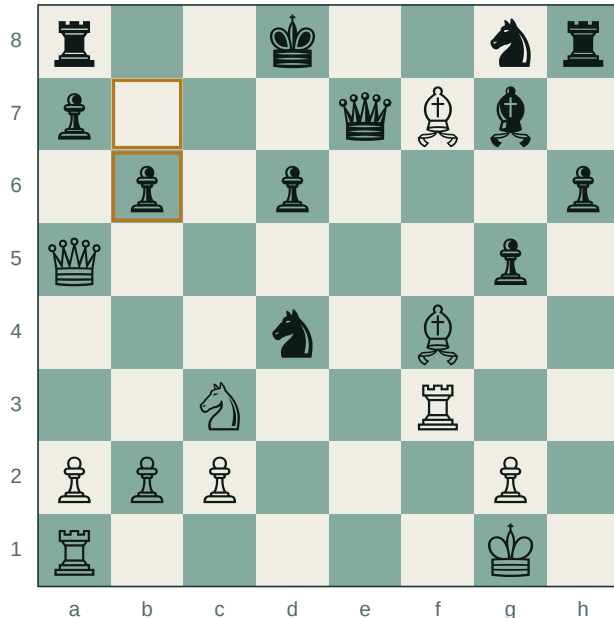


Calculated sacrifices: White, move 19

Calculated sacrifices

White to move



Previous move: 18...b6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

19. Qd5 Nxf3+ 20. gxf3 Rc8 21. Bxd6

19.Qd5 The queen moves from a5 to d5. From d5 it attacks rook on a8 and knight on d4. Recorded reply: **19...Nxf3+**.

20.gxf3 The pawn captures the knight on f3. Recorded reply: **20...Rc8**.

21.Bxd6 The bishop captures the pawn on d6.

At the end, nominal material is White 27 / Black 29 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by -1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -1: the balance goes from -1 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on d8. Absolute pin: pawn on b6.